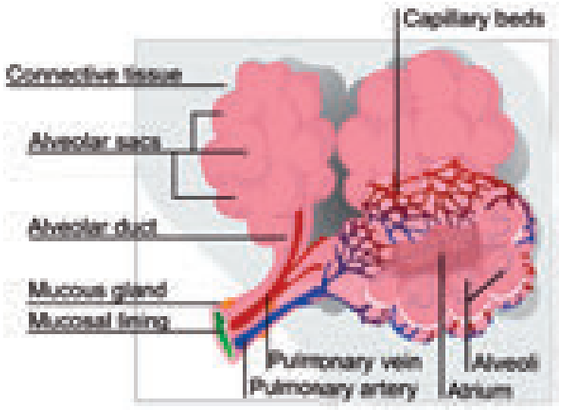
Alveoli

The alveoli are located in the respiratory zone of the lungs. It is the smallest units in the respiratory tract. Human lungs contain about 480 million alveoli.



Alveoli

Each alveolus is surrounded by numerous capillaries and is the site of gas exchange by diffusion.

NOTE: Diaphragm is the major breathing muscle of the body.

Respiratory cycle

The respiratory cycle includes two phases, inspiration or inhaltion of oxygen and expiration or exhalation of carbon dioxide.

NOTE: Each inspiration plus one expiration is one breath. Normally, adults breathe 16 to 20 times per minute or 960 to 1,200 times per hour.

The lungs expand with inspiration and deflate and relax during expiration. Both the expansion and contraction of the lungs are aided by the muscular diaphragm and the intercostal muscles.

Disease of the respiratory tract

- Pneumonia
- Emphysema
- Bronchitis
- Asthma
- Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD)
- Influenza or the "flu"
- Tuberculosis
- Laryngitis
- Pharyngitis
- Lung Cancers
- Dyspnea
- Respiratory arrest

1.9 Endocrine System

The endocrine system provides the body with the hormones that are needed to sustain life and create life. Hypo and hyper secretion of the endocrine glands leads to physiological problems.

NOTE: Endocrine glands are different from exocrine glands. Endocrine glands secrete hormones to an internal part of the body; and exocrine glands secrete substances to the exterior or near the surface of the body. Salivary glands secrete saliva into the mouth and sebaceous glands secrete an oily substance on the skin.

Physiology

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Endocrine system is a control system of ductless glands that secrete hormones within specific organs. Hormones acts as "messengers" and are carried by the blood stream to different cells in the body, which interpret these messages and act on them. It provides an electrochemical connection

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